

DON'T WAIT. AUTOMATE YOUR LIFE, NOW!

Waiting for IoT to kick in so you could lead a smarter life? You definitely can keep waiting or get influenced by this programmer who created python scripts for almost all tasks that took over 90 seconds. Lazy? We think innovative! <http://dgit.in/AutomatedLife>

BEHOLD! THE MALLS OF THE FUTURE

360-degree VR clothing trials, hoverboards to go around, automated bill desks with no queue. What else would you want to see in the technologically advanced malls? We take you to the future, showing you what can the malls in the future have? <http://dgit.in/FutureofMalls>

KEEP EVERYTHING ENCRYPTED

Just when no information or channel is protected enough and there are chances of it getting leaked, we give you a list of security essentials that will guarantee maximum protection and encryption, even in your day to day use. <http://dgit.in/EncryptUrself>

THEY ARE WATCHING YOUR BEHAVIOUR!

In this decade, it is difficult to distinguish between your compulsion to use the internet and to get addicted to it. It is only your habits and behaviour that can given you the answer proven by psychologists. Find out if you're addicted to the Web. <http://dgit.in/Addctd2Int>

SHORTS

The refurbished smartphone buying guide



India has a slew of retailers hawking refurbished smartphones, but can you trust all of them? Here's what you can expect when buying a refurbished smartphone in India.

– By Adamya Sharma

The smartphone industry has, since long, given rise to a slew of supporting industries that have made it possible for us to maximise our experience of using the handheld devices. They keep upping the ante with bigger, thinner, faster, newer and in all ways addictive smartphones and then they make us pay a ransom to own them.

But, the world always finds a way to balance itself out. In this situation too, there are middle men. People who can give us the best of both worlds, or at least hope to. This is the refurbishing industry, a place where smartphones come to die... and then be reborn. These places resuscitate life into devices, price them cheaper than their original unaffordable price tags and then sell them to people like us, who just can't do without that latest iPhone or maybe the S6 Edge. It's called recommerce, the activity of buying and selling refurbished goods.

"Customers across the price segment desire to own a better/higher priced phone but at a budget they wish to spend. This holds good for entry level phones, mid variant phones like YU Yureka and Moto G and high-end like Apple iPhones too," notes Karthik J, Senior Market Analyst, Client Devices, IDC India.

The refurbishing industry finds itself in a constant state of flux and there are occasions when consumers have a difficult time accepting a second hand product or one that has gone through a bit of tinkering post an



accident or even one that was returned to ecommerce merchants like Flipkart or Amazon because someone didn't want them. However, competition in the world of refurbished devices is heating up fast with Amazon and Ebay's signal of intent.

So, we decided to take a look at India's various refurbishing outlets and tell you just what to expect from each one of them. We also used a refurbished device for a week to judge its quality for ourselves. So, from ecommerce to recommerce, read on and find out if refurbished gadgets are a bang for your buck.

Gobol

Gobol is an extension of recycling firm Attero, which sells refurbished smartphones, tablets and supporting accessories. Gobol has divided its smartphone product

inventory into various categories such as surplus, factory seconds, refurbished and pre-owned. This category bifurcation is purely to differentiate between the price of the products. "The reason we have kept different categories is that every consumer will have his own preferred price point. You may want to buy a brand new iPhone and I may be ok with a scratchy iPhone because I really need an iPhone," says Gupta.

The next question that naturally comes to mind is – what about the warranty?

Well, like most other refurbishers, Gobol offers both brand warranty and its own standard 6 month warranty. Brand warranty here refers to the left-over warranty of a device from the date of its original purchase. So if I bought a Samsung Galaxy S6 and decided to sell it to Attero after 6 months, that time period is excluded from the phones warranty period when Attero sells it to its customers. All products under 'Surplus' and 'Super Buy' category and most of the products under 'Carton Damaged' and 'Refurbished' carry manufacturer warranty, unless specified otherwise.

The second type is Gobol's seller warranty which is applicable on 'Refurbished' and 'Pre-owned' products only.

Pricing of smartphones on sale with Gobol is determined by an algorithm developed by Attero itself. Rohan explains that "We have an algorithm that we have developed in house which consists of multiple things like brand, quality, warranty, life-